RELIANCE JEWELS





Isha Ambani
Executive Director, Reliance Retail Ventures Ltd

TURNOVER
Not Available
Reliance Jewels is a part of Reliance Retail Ventures Ltd

NO. OF STORES
380+
showrooms and shop-in shops

"WE HAVE AMBITIOUS PLANS TO ENTER THE LUXURY JEWELLERY SEGMENT WITH A CURATED, DESIGN-LED EXPERIENCE..."
(At the 47th Annual General Meeting of Reliance Industries Ltd, Aug. 29)

like Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Maharashtra, Gujarat, it remains nominal and we plan to increase it going forward," says CEO Baby George. Similarly, Reliance Jewels operates 380+ stores in showrooms and shop-in shops across 200-plus cities.

With aggressive expansion, you may think the market is becoming crowded, but experts think otherwise. "The opportunity is huge, and organised players are growing by capturing the share of the unorganised sector," says Anuj Sethi, senior director at CRISIL Ratings. A lot has changed too in the decades since the last big players entered the market—from consumer aspirations and buying preferences to retail experiences and technology backend, explains Sandeep Kohli, CEO, Novel Jewels. "These shifts present opportunities for us, as we don't carry any legacy baggage and we will leverage our understanding of this new ecosystem to create brand differentiation."

Design plays a pivotal role in the buying decisions of modern consumers. They want jewellery that reflects their personal style and aesthetics. And the market is responding with innovative designs

Established players are taking note of the increasing competition and changing market dynamics. "Two to three years ago, we started an extensive retail transformation exercise for our stores, where we evaluated each location to determine whether we needed to add new stores, expand or relocate existing ones, or include newer categories in wedding or high-end jewellery to better serve the new realities of that area," says Ajoy Chawla, CEO of the jewellery division at Titan Company. For instance, some smaller 3,000 sq. ft stores were expanded, or a dedicated floor for bridal jewellery with a lounge to enable consumers to try jewellery with their wedding attire, or customer event spaces, were added. Over 150 Tanishq stores now have dedicated wedding floors. As a result, the brand saw a 16 per cent same-store sales growth.

A MATTER OF DESIGN

Design has become a crucial factor in the buying decisions of today's consumers. They want jewellery that reflects their personal style and aesthetics. New brides are taking their cues from Bollywood actresses—be it Anushka Sharma's uncut diamond and pearl choker, or Alia Bhatt's magnificent Sabyasachi Heritage Jewellery, adorned with a statement *matha patti* and uncut diamond necklace. "Plain gold jewellery is restrictive and can be worn only on weddings, but I can easily wear polki on several occasions, even pair its earrings with a black dress," says 36-year-old Ridhima Kukreja, a Gurugram-based brand manager, for whom it was the jewellery of choice for her wedding last year. And the market is responding with innovative designs that cater to this evolving taste. "Through Indriya," says Abhishek Rastogi, head, design, "I wanted to create a world where traditions and modernity thrive together; where our centuries-old heritage shapes the way we create and is reimagined for modern times in our craft."

With a new crop of young Indians look-